Linking Phrases

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Why are Linking Phrases Important?

In academic writing, it is imperative to present an **argument clearly and cohesively**.

In addition, you may be required **to discuss and evaluate** existing research or ideas about the topic under discussion.

The appropriate use of ‘discourse markers,’ that is, words or phrases that signal a relationship, can **reveal and reinforce** the direction that your argument is taking, and make clear the relations between sections of your writing.

How to use ‘Nevertheless’ or ‘However’

-**At the beginning of a new sentence, followed by a comma;**

It is a well-known fact that conservation projects can be costly. **Nevertheless / However,** they need to be prioritised.

-**Or in a second sentence, enclosed by commas;**

It is a well-known fact that conservation projects can be costly. Nevertheless, they need to be prioritised. People point out, **nevertheless, / however,** that they need to be prioritised.

Be Careful!

Words like “although” and “because” are called *subordinating conjunctions*. This means that they introduce clauses which cannot stand on their own.

Smith (2015) argues that the period should be reassessed. Although other researchers disagree.

The second sentence in this example is a fragment, because it consists only of the “although” clause.

How can we fix this?

We can fix this in two different ways:

*Smith (2015) argues that the period should be reassessed**, although** other researchers disagree.*

*Smith (2015) argues that the period should be reassessed**. However,** other researchers disagree.*

Starting a sentence with *also*, *and*, or *so*

While the words “also,” “and,” and “so” are used in academic writing, they are considered too informal when used at the start of a sentence.

- *Also, a second round of testing was carried out.*

To fix this issue, we can either move the transition word to a different point in the sentence or use a more formal alternative.

- *A second round of testing was **also** carried out.*

What can I use instead of “also” as a linking word?

- ***Additionally,** a second round of testing was carried out.*

Linking Words - Activity

Sequencing ideas - ***to indicate a chronological sequence of ideas***	**Addition –** ***to add an idea***	**For comparison –** ***to show how things are similar***	**For contrast –** ***To show how things are different***
First(ly),	*In addition,*	*Similarly,*	*Alternatively,*
For illustration – to provide examples	***The cause of things – to attribute the reasons for something occurring***	***For emphasis - to put forward an idea more forcefully***	***Drawing a conclusion***
For instance,	*Due to,*	*In fact,*	*In conclusion,*

Sequencing ideas - to indicate a chronological sequence of ideas	*Addition – to add an idea*	*For comparison – to show how things are similar*	*For contrast – To show how things are different*
First(ly), • **Second(ly),** • **Next,** • **Following,** • **Subsequently,**	**In addition,** • **Apart from this,** • **As well (as),** • **Moreover,** • **Further/Furthermore,**	**Similarly,** • **Correspondingly,** • **For the same reason,** • **In comparison,** • **Equally,**	**Alternatively,** • **Conversely,** • **However,** • **Although,** • **Nonetheless,** • **Nevertheless,**
For illustration – to provide examples	*The cause of things – to attribute the reasons for something occurring*	*For emphasis - to put forward an idea more forcefully*	*Drawing a conclusion*
For instance, • **A further instance of this is…** • **Another example is…** • **Such as,** • **Thus,**	**Due to,** • **The result of,** • **The effect of,** • **Because,** • **Since,**	**In fact,** • **Indeed,** • **Indisputably,** • **Most importantly,** • **Unquestionably,**	**In conclusion,** • **Finally,** • **As a result,** • **To summarise,** • **To conclude,**

Task B

a) However, /Nevertheless,
b) First(ly), (Now – informal)
c) In other words,
d) Furthermore / In addition,
e) also
f) such as
g) Alternatively,
h) In addition, / Furthermore,
i) Nevertheless, / However,
j) If
k) but
l) Similarly, (Besides)

Check your Work

When you are editing your next written assignment, ask yourself the following questions as you read through your work:

- ✓ Does the start of my paragraph give my reader enough information about what the paragraph will be about?
- ✓ Does my paragraph add to or elaborate on a point made previously and, if so, have I made this explicit with an appropriate linking word / phrase?
- ✓ Does my paragraph introduce a completely new point or a different viewpoint to before and, if so, have I explicitly shown this with a suitable connective?
- ✓ Have I used different connectives instead of repeating the same ones?

- The designer used different patterns. The outfit has a strong shape. The materials are new. Overall, the look is harmonious.

- The designer used different patterns; **however**, the outfit has a strong shape. **Moreover**, the materials are new, **so** the overall look is harmonious.

Task C

1. The artist experimented with colour. The composition lacks balance. The painting has a unique style. The overall effect is disjointed.

The artist experimented with colour; *however*, the composition lacks balance. *Nevertheless*, the painting has a unique style. *As a result*, the overall effect is (or feels rather) disjointed.

2. The performance had high energy. The choreography was repetitive. The music choice complemented the movements. It lacked originality.

The performance had high energy; *however*, the choreography was repetitive. *In contrast,* the music choice effectively complemented the movements. *Despite* these positive elements, it lacked originality.

3. The animation used vibrant colours. The character movements were not smooth. The story was engaging. The overall quality suffered.

The animation used vibrant colours. *Nevertheless*, the character movements were not smooth. *On the other hand*, the story was engaging. *Therefore*, while the narrative was captivating, the overall quality suffered *due to* the technical shortcomings.

4. The game's design was visually stunning. The user interface was difficult to navigate. The storyline was immersive. The gameplay felt frustrating.

The game's design was visually stunning. *Even so*, the user interface was difficult to navigate. *Furthermore*, while the storyline was immersive, *ultimately*, the gameplay felt frustrating. **OR**

The game's design was visually stunning; *however*, the user interface was difficult to navigate. *Although* the storyline was immersive, the gameplay felt frustrating *due to* poor control mechanics.

5. The photographer captured the essence of the scene. The lighting was inconsistent. The use of angles added depth. The result was uneven.

The photographer captured the essence of the scene; *nevertheless*, the lighting was inconsistent. *Even though* the use of angles added depth, *overall*, the result was uneven.

6. The journalist provided thorough research. The article lacked emotional depth. The facts were well-presented. It failed to engage readers.

The journalist provided thorough research. *In contrast*, the article lacked emotional depth. *Even though* the facts were well-presented, *as a result*, it failed to engage readers.

Showing Synthesis:

Some ways to demonstrate synthesis in your writing is to compare and contrast multiple sources. Below are some examples of sentence structures that demonstrate synthesis:

- Synthesis that indicates agreement/support:
- Source A asserts that… Source B agrees when he or she states…
- According to both A & B…
- The combined conclusions of sources B & C seem to indicate that…
- The evidence shows that…
- Source B is correct that…
- Source C makes a convincing case when she argues…
- The author of this paper agrees with Source A’s conclusion that…